



FLAT CHAT NEWSLETTER
AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC
ABN: 87 630 303 136

VOL. 10 ISSUE

Mar 2023

#3

COMING EVENTS

MARCH

2nd Monthly Meeting
4th Central Coast W'shop
8th Committee Meeting
11th Sydney Workshop
18h Fish & Chip Run
20th HARS Visit

APRIL

1st Central Coast W'shop
6th Monthly Meeting
12th Committee Meeting
23rd Thirlmere Rail Museum

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2022 Presentation Lunch Countdown – 5 February

Words and photos by Julie Lee



T minus 7 days: Social Secretary Bruce Ewan is out on site checking to make sure everything will be okay on the day.

T minus 4: A recently recuperated Garry is out on the ride-on mower making sure the weeds, er I mean lawn, looks good.

T minus 3: On his way home from the general meeting, Colin "have I got a deal for you" Rule drops off the Club's gazebo and some tablecloths borrowed from Greg Strange and Dianne Lawler.

T minus 2: The hired tables and chairs have been delivered and

now we're playing table chess under the pergola, wondering how on earth we're going to fit 60+ people under cover. We quickly realise we don't have enough tables, so it's on the phone to Colin to see if we can borrow some of his.

T minus 1: Garry heads on over to the Rules' in the BJ9 (RAV 4) to pick up the extra tables and chairs and Colin's gazebo. We move pot plants out of the way, put up one of the gazebos, clean the house, and play more table chess. I think we finally have a layout that works. We hope that Sunday isn't as warm and windy.



POST: AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 2754
North Parramatta NSW 1750

EMAIL: enquiries@austinhaileynsw.com.au
WEB: www.austinhaileynsw.com.au
FB: www.facebook.com/groups/681723625314952/

Our monthly meetings are held at Strathfield Golf Club, 52 Weeroona Rd, Strathfield NSW 2135 on the 1st Thursday of each month commencing at 7.30pm.

Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner in the bistro from 5.30pm.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

Presentation Lunch

Firstly, thank you to all of the people involved in organising the Presentation Lunch and making it the success it was, and to all of the members who turned up on the day when old acquaintances were renewed and new ones made. More details are in this Newsletter.

Chapters

The committee has been encouraging the formation of regional chapters of the AHOC for the past year or so.

This activity has proved a great success with the Central Coast Chapter and the Central West Chapter now well established and the Mid-North Coast Chapter kicking off on Saturday 25 February.

The Southern Highlands and Illawarra Chapters are ready to hold their first event in the form of a joint event, with the opportunity for Austin-Healey owners to meet at the Historical Aircraft Restoration Society (HARS) at Albion Park for an exciting Austin-Healey photo opportunity.



HARS has made available to us, the Qantas Boeing 747 that permanently resides at the Museum for a photo opportunity. The Austin-Healeys will be positioned under the wings of the 747 for photos.

So, take the opportunity to get your car and camera out and enjoy a day at the HARS. See details elsewhere in the Newsletter.

Hybrid Meetings

Another thing the committee has been discussing over the past period is hybrid meetings. This would allow members outside the Sydney area as well as those within, who for various reasons are unable to attend in person, the opportunity to dial in and be

part of the meeting.

Strathfield Golf Club will make this facility available to us and, in the next couple of weeks I have scored myself an invitation to observe the practicalities of how this will operate. Whether this is successful depends mostly on those of you who don't currently attend the general meetings, but would like to be part of it and also depends on the committee to ensure that it is an enjoyable experience for you. I therefore have a request that if you would "dial in" to be part of our meeting, can you please email me on webmaster@austinhealeynsw.com.au and let me know that you are in for the experience.

COMMITTEE LIST - 2023

Club Patron—Ross Bond

President - Jim Phillips
8 Belina Ave.,
Wyoming NSW 2250
0413 589 306
jpjimbeau@gmail.com

Vice-President - Geoff Smith
0458 777 339
m.gpsmith@bigpond.com

Secretary - Julie Lee
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Technical Officer - Greg Strange
02 9319 2299
gregorymstrange@gmail.com

Club Registrar - Patrick Quinn
(Inc Conditional Registration)
Please send all Conditional Registration documents to Patrick's postal address at left

Public Relations - Ross Penman
0408 465 547
penmans@bigpond.com

Webmaster - Jim Phillips
0413 589 306
jpjimbeau@gmail.com

Public Officer - Alan Mitchell
PO Box 123
Marulan 2579
0412 898 656
mitchellaj@ozemail.com.au

Non-Committee Positions
CSCA Delegate - Colin Goldsmith

Librarian - Ronnie Strange

CMC Delegates - Ray Roberts
Greg Strange

Welfare Officer - Pamela Ross 0408 201 226

Display Day Coordinators - Ross & Jenny Penman

Conditional Registration Inspectors - Neville Storton
0414 472 877
Geoff Smith
0458 777 339

Assn of British Car Clubs Reps - Christine Lyttle

National Assn Delegates - Gordon Lynas & Jim Phillips

AHOC Life Members - Don Read, Joe Armour, Christine Lyttle, Patrick Quinn, Terry Bancroft, Ray Roberts and David Mould.

If you want to send something by post, the Club's address is:-

AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 2754
North Parramatta NSW 1750

It would be appreciated if there were no phone calls to committee members after 9:00 PM.

EXHAUST LEAKS



By Patrick Quinn
(02) 4567 7380
0417 673 065
p_quinn@tpg.com.au

Greetings and welcome to the March 2023 issue of the *Flat Chat Newsletter* and I hope that within its digital pages there is something you will find informative and perhaps entertaining.

I am pleased to say that I've been blessed with quite a lot of material for this issue.

Thanks to Scott Graham for the article on forged pistons and with Graham Healey now the happy owner of a 3000 Mk1 there was an article in the making there too. Lots of Club stuff as well including the wonderfully important minutes. You do read the minutes don't you? Although with my Registrar's hat on, I do wonder if everyone does, as a week doesn't go past without someone asking a question that is easily found and answered within Flat Chat. Lots of news on what's happening socially within our club too.

Thanks to Julie Lee for her Page

1 article on the Presentation Lunch. An enjoyable article on an enjoyable day. Thank you to also to Bryan Levy for his photos and to Andrew James as well. Such things go to make up each issue of the *Flat Chat Newsletter*.

I have been thinking of late the number of times the Quinn Austin-Healey has been taken here, there and everywhere on the back of a tilt tray or trailer. Just last week away it went again to have its engine installed and it's coming back in a day or two the same way. Over the last decade there was a trip from Griffith, trips away to have the engine bay repainted, four or six times to a safe haven when bush fires were threatening and a few times for paint or mechanical rectification. I certainly hope that within a month or so it can move about under its own power.

The engine is now back in place, as is the gearbox. Of course this didn't go as smoothly as it should, as fitting a six-cylinder engine through a 100 front shroud is tricky. So tricky in fact that it was caught on the passenger footwell that had been significant modified in 1954 by the DHMC. Suddenly 'bang', down it went causing damage to the front shroud. Thankfully the good people at Shannons accepted the claim and it's about to enjoy quality time at the Cessario's Platinum Smash Repairs. Oh well!

Trust you enjoy this issue of the *Flat Chat Newsletter*. Thanks again to those members who took the trouble to put words together and send them in with a photo or two. It is very much appreciated. Please keep it up as after all there would be no point in publishing Flat Chat Newsletter each month without them.



On the Road Again!

Monthly Meetings

**We meet on the first Thursday of the month at Strathfield Golf Club
Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm**



Minutes of the General Meeting

Thursday, 2 February 2023

Venue - Strathfield Golf Club

Meeting commenced at 7:45pm.

ATTENDEES

There were 25 members present (refer attendance list for details). Dianne Lawlor was celebrating a significant birthday, but still chose to attend the meeting!

VISITORS & NEW MEMBERS

David Stevenson, Austin-Healey Sprite Mk I Bugeye Sprite owner, attended with the intention of rejoining.

APOLOGIES

Joe Armour, Patricia Bancroft, Jeff Burton, Mal French, Amer Khoury, Garry & Julie Lee, Kris & Kath Long, John & Judy Sherman

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

Resolved that the minutes of the General Meeting held 3 November 2022, as published in the December 2022 issue of Flat Chat, be verified as a correct record of that meeting.

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

Jim reported on the saga (still ongoing) of trying to update the Club's signatories with Westpac.

In chapter news, each of the Club chapters (Central Coast, Mid-North Coast, Southern Highlands/South Coast and Central West) had planned or were planning events for February and March.

Following on from the resolution at the AGM about honorary membership, Graham Healey had confirmed acceptance of his invitation, but Jim hadn't yet heard back from Bob Cutler.

VICE-PRESIDENT'S REPORT

No report.

SECRETARY'S REPORT

Julie's report consisted of a snapshot of some of the spam that regularly turned up in the email account! Jim Phillips, for Julie Lee

TREASURER'S REPORT

Club funds as at 31 January 2023:

Debit card	\$228.54
Main Account	\$45,419.23
Cash Reserve	\$21,930.90
Charlie's Run	\$1,844.06
Term Deposit	\$70,000.00

The main account included almost \$22K for the National Rally.

Non-rally related income was for the Presentation Lunch and interest earned. Non-rally related expenses were for the Presentation Lunch, trophies, postage and software.

Jenny Penman (with Jim's assistance due to the previously mentioned issues with Westpac...)

SOCIAL SECRETARIES' REPORT

The dynamic duo of Bruce and Denis provided an update on the many events they had lined up for the first six months of the year.

WELFARE OFFICER'S REPORT

Pamela had sent cards to David Williamson, Ray & Muriel Roberts' family, Shirley & David Mould, Peter Van Dyk and Garry & Julie Lee. Unfortunately, she couldn't send one to herself (for a recent fall) so Alan Mitchell offered to do so.

WEBMASTER'S REPORT

Jim advised that the RSVP facility on the website had now been updated.

MEMBERSHIP

Christine provided an update on membership.

RALLY REPORT

Gordon provided an update on the upcoming National Rally.

EDITOR'S REPORT

Patrick provided a status on the delivery of Flat Chat the previous evening.

REGISTRAR

Patrick didn't have anything particular to report except that members were still asking him questions

about the process for historic vehicle registration despite it being explained in every issue of Flat Chat!

HISTORIAN

No report.

LIBRARIAN

Nothing to report.

TECHNICAL OFFICER/CLUB EQUIPMENT/SPARE PARTS

Greg advised that SU fuel pump kits were now available online.

PUBLIC RELATIONS REPORT

Nothing to report.

CMC REPORT

Given the large number of clubs in the CMC, they were now asking for no more than three members from each club to attend the 60th anniversary lunch.

ASSOCIATION OF BRITISH CAR CLUBS

The first meeting for the year wasn't until March, so nothing to report.

CSCA REPORT

The Supersprint dates for 2023 were now available on the CSCA website.

REGALIA

Colin was back to his best with trying to part members from their money with some great deals!

SHOW OR TELL

Alan Mitchell showed:

- NRMA Motorfest badge collection covering 1996-2005.
- Medallions from CMC Eastern Creek, 2001 and 2003-5, All British Day 1998, 2004 & 2005, and 2022 Australian Historic Festival Winton "50th Anniversary of the Austin Healey".
- Matchbox Austin-Healey five-pack and Hot Wheels Austin-Healey 5-pack (neither are available retail).

Patrick told of issues with their car and really didn't want to hear about it any longer.

GENERAL BUSINESS

Alan advised that the bookbinding services in West Ryde (used for binding *Flat Chat*) had closed so he'd be looking for alternatives.

Meeting concluded at 9:00pm.



Thank you to Bryan Levy for these two photos taken at a recent Berrima Cars and Coffee. While I recognise the red over white BN6 as belonging to Greg Barnsley, not so the white 3000. Not sure either about the multi-coloured BMW.

Social Report

Bruce Ewan 0432 096 493
Bruce.ewan1@gmail.com
Denis Kasza 0407 492 008
deniskasza@gmail.com

Presentation Lunch

The weather gods blessed the 2023 Presentation Lunch. Beautiful sunshine, warm weather and a soft breeze saw many Austin-Healeys come out of hibernation and hit the highway. Cars coming from Sydney met at the Old Berowra Toll Gates and were led by Denis Kasza along the Old Pacific Highway through to Julie and Garry Lee's new home at Niagara Park.

While there was a large contingent from the Central Coast, members still travelled from North, South, East and West delivering a really enjoyable day and one of the most interesting gatherings held in the last few years.

Over 60 people, and 21 Austin-Healeys lined up on the lawns, along the edge of the creek and providing a wonderful backdrop to the lush National Park behind.

The catered lunch consisted of pork or lamb, four different salads, bread rolls, with dessert being a birthday cake large enough for all to share, as we sang Happy Birthday to Diane Lawlor.

There were many new members, plus a number of maiden journeys, including the first run for Neville Stirton's 'new' 3000.

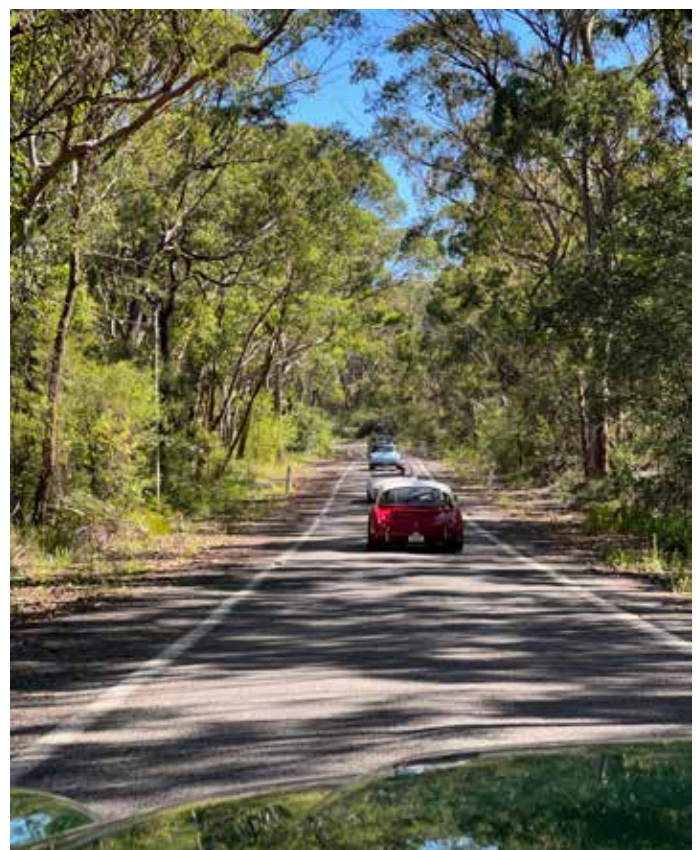


Under the bonnet of Neville Stirton's 'new' 3000.

A huge thanks to Julie and Garry Lee for making this a most enjoyable gathering.

Meeting at the Old Berowra Tollgates and Convoy Run

A total of 21 people in 13 vehicles met from 9.30am at the Old Berowra Tollgates, departing for Niagara Park at 10.15am. We shared the parking area with about 40 members and cars from the Subaru WRX Club, who entertained us with their departure. Our convoy then proceeded in style along the Old Pacific Highway, interrupted by a brief, but unintended excursion onto the freeway by some members, reuniting at the Calga Interchange.



Thanks to Jenny Penman for the above two photos



Social Report Cont'

Participating members and cars were: Neville Stirton (3000), Rod Richards (3000), Bryan Levy (3000), Vince and Natalie Cessario (3000), George and Liz Goodare (100M), Ross and Jenny Penman (3000), Harley Boggis (3000), Daryl and Cheryl Dobe 100; Greg Strange and Dianne Lawlor (Sprite) and the 'BJ9s' of Ray and Muriel Roberts Colin Goldsmith, Keith and Joan Drake, and Denis Kasza and Susie Doctor (Austin A99).

The arrival of the convoy at Julie and Garry Lee's led to the impressive lineup of Austin-Healeys and the very enjoyable Presentation Lunch. A big thank you to all the Committee members who contributed so much to the day's smooth running and an especially big thank you to Julie and Garry Lee, for their generosity in hosting the event.

For the list of members who presented with awards see the cover story.

Upcoming Events

Event: **Central Coast Chapter Technical Day**

Date: Saturday March 4, 2023

Times: 9:15am – 12:00 Midday

Address: 109 Humphreys Rd, South Kincumber NSW 2251

Cost: Zero

Bring: Something to contribute to morning tea, eg cake, biscuit, slice etc.

Event: **OASIS Valley Heights Rail Museum**

Date: Tuesday March 7, 2023

MEET: McDonalds, Cnr. Groves Ave & Windsor Rd. McGraths Hill

DEPART: 9.00am.

BOOKINGS: Murray Irwin 0449 896 008 mcix19@outlook.com by Saturday March 4 for catering

Event: **Sydney Technical Day – Mortlake Surf Life Saving Club** © (on the mangroves)

Date: Saturday March 11, 2023

Times: 9:15am – 12:00 Midday

Address: 2 Bennett St, Mortlake

Parking enter via the lower carpark on Edwin St.

Cost: Zero

Bring: Something to contribute to morning tea, eg cake, biscuit, slice etc

Register: PLEASE register in advance to the above

Event: **Saturday 18 March – Fish & Chips Run, Paradise Cafe, Lower Portland**

Time: 5.30pm to 8.30pm

Address: Paradise Cafe, 766 River Rd, Lower Portland

For members wanting a convoy run, meet at McGraths Hill Maccas, 242 Windsor Rd, Vineyard at 5.30pm, for a 6pm departure.

Special parking overlooking the river will be provided at Paradise Cafe

Register: Paradise Cafe will need to know numbers, so please RSVP by Monday March 13

RSVP on AHOC Website or by contacting the above:

Event: **AHOC Illawarra and Southern Highlands Chapters - Inaugural gathering**

Date: Monday 20th March 20, 2023

Time: 10am

Address: Historical Aircraft Society (HARS), Shellharbour Airport, 54 Airport Rd, Albion Park Rail, NSW 2527

Parking will be a display of Austin-Healeys on the Boeing 747 compound, under the wings of the 747. Morning tea or lunch will be available at the HARS Museum Cafe. Guided tours of the HARS Museum will be available.

Register: To confirm your parking spot, RSVP to John Thornton, 0419 266 284 John.thornton@outlook.com.

Event: **Thirlmere Rail Museum**

Date: Sunday 23 April, 2023

Time: 11am to 2.30pm

Address: 11 Barbour Rd., Thirlmere

Depart: Frank Partridge VC rest stop at 10am for a 10.30 departure.

Note: Cafe and parking available at Thirlmere.

The March meeting is scheduled for 7.30pm Thursday the 2nd at Strathfield Golf Club Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Come along from 5.30pm and enjoy dinner in the bistro with your fellow club members.

Social Report cont'

Event: Central Coast Chapter Technical Day

Date: Saturday May 6, 2023

Times: 9:15am – 12:00 Midday

Address: 109 Humphreys Rd, South Kincumber
NSW 2251

Cost: Zero

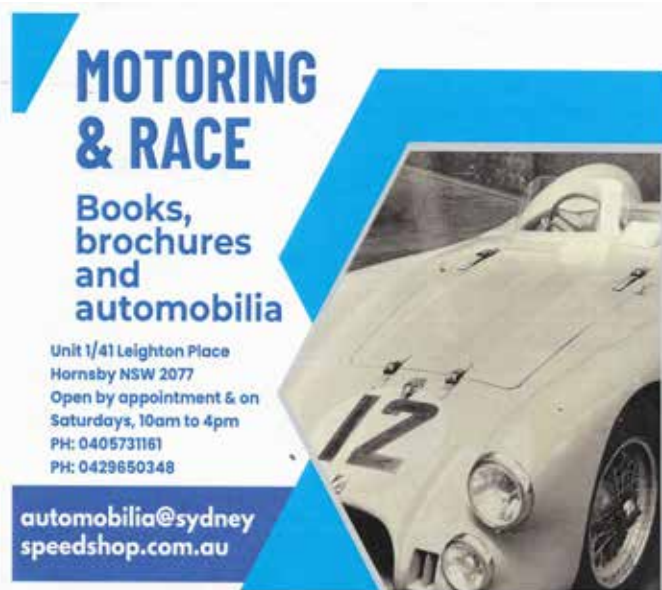
Bring: Something to contribute to morning tea, eg
cake, biscuit, slice etc

Event: Sydney Technical Day

Date: Saturday May 13, 2023

Times: 9:15am – 12:00 Midday

Address: North Shore Location (TBC)



Cost: Zero

Bring: Something to contribute to morning tea, eg
cake, biscuit, slice etc

Register: PLEASE register in advance to the above.

Following on from this workshop there is the option
to visit the Motoring & Race Book & Automobilia
Shop

Unit 1/ 41 Leighton Place, Hornsby NSW 2077

Event: Central Coast Chapter Technical Day

Date: Saturday June 3, 2023

Times: 9:15am – 12:00 Midday

Address: 109 Humphreys Rd, South Kincumber
NSW 2251

Cost: Zero

Bring: Something to contribute to morning tea, eg
cake, biscuit, slice etc

Event: Sydney Technical Day – Greg Strange Motor Mechanic

Date: Saturday June 10, 2023

Times: 9:15am – 12:00 Midday

Address: 117 Cleveland, Darlington

Topic: Working on the BMC Production Line in
Sydney.

Cost: Zero

Bring: Something to contribute to morning tea, eg
cake, biscuit, slice etc

Register: PLEASE register in advance to the above.



Thanks to Terry Bancroft for sending this.
Yes it is an Austin-Healey 3000 with a V8 and Fibrefab body.
I suppose someone has to like it.

MAR
18



SAT NIGHT FISH & CHIPS

**6.30 to 8.30 pm PARADISE
CAFE, LOWER PORTLAND**

**Meet at McGraths Hill
Maccas 5.30 dep 6pm.
RSVP Denis Kasza**



Historic Vehicle Registration News

If you have a car on Historic Vehicle Registration you should read this.

With the Hunter Valley National Rally on the horizon, it is perhaps appropriate to remind members with vehicles on NSW Conditional Registration of what they can do and what they should not.

Succinctly, if you attend the National Rally in your Conditionally Registered car, the travel to and from the Rally from your home (or where the car is normally garaged) must be by the most practicable route and no entry needs to be made in the Log Book. During the Rally you can use your vehicle on all the runs, events etc. and again, you do not need to make an entry in the Log Book. Should however, you choose to deviate from the most

practicable route to and from the Rally or do the same during the planned runs, say to visit friends or see Aunt Joan, that specific trip becomes personal use and it must be entered in the Log Book.

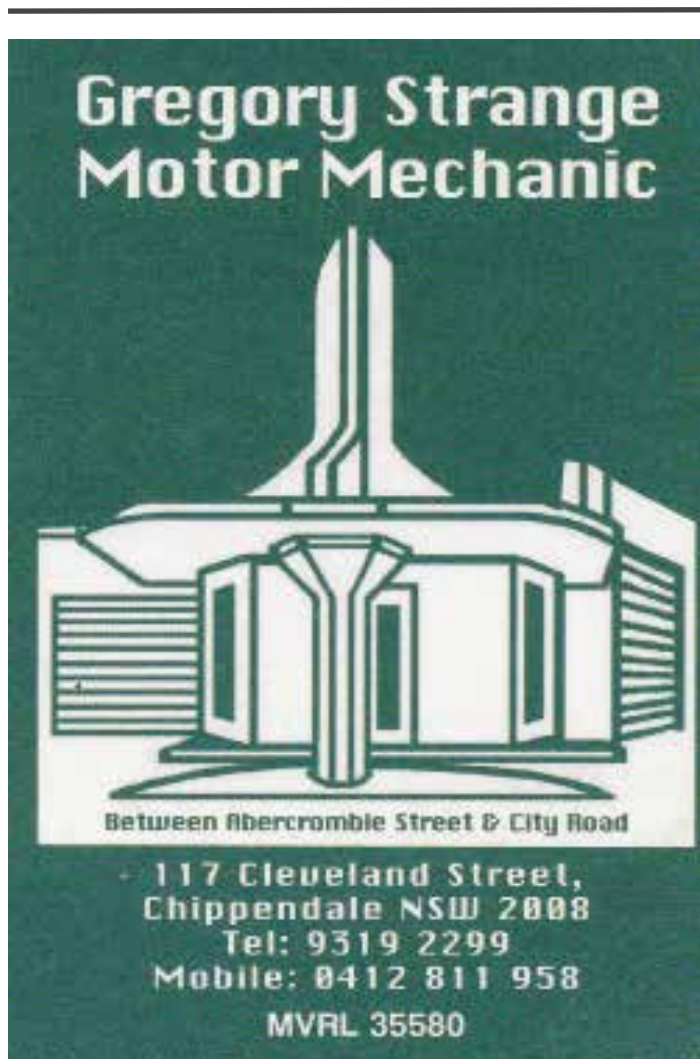
It's best to carry some form of proof (printed copy of *Flat Chat*) when you are travelling to (or back) and during the Rally indicating that you are attending the event. You may be pulled over and be asked to show your Log Book.

By the way, should you sell your Conditionally Registered car, the registration is not transferrable, and the buyer has purchased an unregistered vehicle. This simply means that the buyer cannot drive away without making alternative arrangements.

In case you're wondering, I am still being asked how to renew Conditional Registration. Again, the necessary steps are indicated below.

- Once you have received the renewal papers from Transport for NSW, arrange for your vehicle to be inspected for roadworthiness by either an Authorised Inspection Station or one of the volunteer AHOC inspection officers. See page 2 of this Flat Chat for their contact details. Remember all vehicles, including Historic vehicles need to be inspected and passed as roadworthy.
- Complete the left-hand side of the "Historic Vehicle Declaration" and post it to me at my home address (See page 2 of this Flat Chat for my address) along with an indication that your car is roadworthy or a copy of the pink slip. Please include a stamped self-addressed envelope. There is no need to send me the registration certificate. Do not post me the documents by Registered Post as that just slows down the process as I have to go to the post office to accept a registered postal item.
- Once returned, either go to your local Services NSW office to do the renewal or post to Transport for NSW in Parkes. That address can be found on the registration papers.

**DON'T FORGET THE STAMPED
SELF-ADDRESSED ENVELOPE.**



**Gregory Strange
Motor Mechanic**

Between Abercrombie Street & City Road

117 Cleveland Street,
Chippendale NSW 2008
Tel: 9319 2299
Mobile: 0412 811 958
MVRL 35580

Mid-North Coast Chapter Inaugral Meeting

By Phil Lorking



Kerrie and Colin Rule (100), Lyndal and Chris Hatch, Zeke, Matt, Beatrix and Rebekah Cohen (100/6), Barbara and Glenn Robinson (3000 Mk1), Diane and Alan Bryson (Sprite Mk1), Tony Ash, Phil and Anthea Lorking (3000 Mk1) Glen Nisbet (Sprite Mk1) left early.

The Inaugural Meeting of the Mid North Coast Chapter of the AHOC was held on Saturday 25th February 2023 at the home (actually shed) of Phil and Anthea Lorking at Croki (Near Taree).

Starting at 9am it was certainly encouraging to have 16 people attending our first meeting which went through to 1pm. Over morning tea, we enjoyed our initial introductions and learnt the backgrounds of everyone.

Following, the meeting went onto problem solving of a couple of the attendees' vehicles and in particular running hot.

The vehicles in attendance were one each Sprite Mk1, 100 and 100/6 along with two 3000 Mk1.

Next month we hope to have another Austin-Healey owner who could not make the initial meeting, to talk about his machine shop and dynamometer business.

It would be wonderful if more people were to attend our next Saturday Workshops at Croki. If interested please call me on 0412 392 362.





Central Coast Chapter Workshop

Thanks to Colin Rule

Well folks, Saturday February 4th was really a day made in heaven. The temperature was around 24° at 9 am, with 12 Austin-Healeys, one Aston Martin DB9 and a racing Sunbeam Alpine along with 22 very eager enthusiasts.

The theme of the day was detailing your Austin-Healey in readiness for the Clubs Awards Presentation Lunch on the following day at Julie and Garry lee's place at Niagara Park.

So it was all systems go with plenty of willing helpers with buckets, lots of suds, sponges and to finish off a good old chamois down. All ending up with a gaggle of very clean classics.

We finished the morning with our traditional coffee, cookies and cake, winding up around 11:30 am. A wonderful day was had by all.

A very big welcome to first time Workshopppers,

David and Sandie Parlour and the other Doug Ross who incidentally introduced me to the Austin-Healey marque back in the mid-60s.

The attendees for the day were Scott Parry-Jones BN4, Louise Hicken BN1, Jenni and Ian Richter, Garry Lee, Ken Offord, Richard Cardew Alpine, Richard Horwood Porsche, Larry Johns BT7 MK1, Doug Ross BJ7 MK2, Roger Ramsey, Adam Lethlean and Helen Vance BT7 Mk1, Lew McAllan Sprite MK1, Mark McAllan BJ8, Chris Jenkins BT7 Mk1, Jim Phillips BN4, Christine Little, David and Sandie Parlour Aston Martin DB9 as well as Kerrie and yours truly in the BN2.

The next workshop will be held at Jenny and Ian Richter's home. The address is 20 Fern Road, Ourimbah. Oh yes, it's on rain, hail or shine. The theme of the day is checking out Ian's new BN1 project. All welcome, start time is 9am. Take care and Happy Healeying. Kerrie and Col Rule.



Presentation Lunch cont'

Sunday 5 February – Lift off, and it's all hands-on deck!

9:30am: Barry's Spit Roast is on the doorstep to set up.

10:30am: Bruce and Jim Phillips are on hand to help direct traffic as the various convoys arrive. Marque vehicles are escorted through to the rear of the property and BJ9s are asked to skulk around at the front.

11:00am: Colin and Kerrie arrive with extra coffee cups and Colin takes charge of gazebo placement. Jenny and Ross Penman bring dessert, cleverly disguised as Dianne's 60th birthday cake, plus Christine Lyttle has made some delicious rocky road.

11:30am: The "official" start time and we already have around 40 people wandering around having a chat, looking at cars, or sitting in the shade under a pergola.

12:00pm: Lunch is served! Bruce makes sure everyone forms an orderly queue to partake of the delicious roasts, baked potatoes and salads provided by Barry's Spit Roast.



1:00pm: President Jim is on microphone duties as it's time to hand out the silverware, with the worthy winners being:

2022 Concours and Display Day

100: George and Liz Goodare, 100M

100/6: Mark Wilkinson BN4

3000 Mk1: Richard Lloyd, BN7

3000 Mk2: Joint winners: John and Kate Burch BT7, Richard Horwood BN7

3000 Mk2 Convertible: Allan Whitehouse

3000 Mk3: Bryan Levy.

2022 Competition – Ross Bond Trophy: Patrick Townshend

2022 Club Champions: Gordon Lynas & Louise Lynas



Jim Phillips presents Gordon and Louise Lynas with the Club Champions trophies.

2022 Scribe of the Year: Ron Strange

2022 Hard Luck Trophy

And then it was time for the trophy that nobody really wants to win. Courtesy of their "Tassie Trauma", when after slowing down for a speed bump (which we all know is critical in low-slung marque cars!), an impatient driver ran into the back of their car and caused \$40,000 in damage, the trophy went to Greg Strange and Dianne Lawlor.



Jim Phillips with Diane Lawlor and Greg Strange

President Jim reminded everyone to send in nominations for the 2022 Club Person, AKA Alan Jones Memorial Trophy.

1:30pm: With the awards out of the way, it was dessert time, but not before Dianne got to blow the candles out on her cake and everyone wished her a very happy significant birthday!

3:00pm: Lunch is officially over and the clean-up crew go to work to stack tables and chairs and help clear away the food.

Presentation Lunch cont*

4:00pm: Garry and I wave farewell to the last of the attendees, Garry crashes out, and I breathe a sigh of relief that it all went really well.

Thank you to the 61 attendees, some of whom had

travelled quite a distance, and the very impressive tally of 22 marque cars. And thank you also to everyone that helped both before and on the day to make it a very successful.



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PAINTED SILOS TOUR - 4th to 8th September 2023 - Itinerary

Monday - SEPTEMBER 4th

Depart Sydney
Travel to HARDEN MURRUMBURRAH
Silo location – Neill Street, Harden

Continue to GRENFELL

Silo location – 30 West Street, Grenfell

Continue to WEST WYALONG for overnight stay at either:-

CAMEO MOTEL, 263 Neeld Street, \$120/night, 6 rooms

Phone (02) 6972 2255

Or

COLONIAL MOTOR INN, 4 Ungarie Road, \$ 130/night, 10 rooms

Phone (02) 6972 2611

TOTAL 530 KMS FOR DAY



Grenfell



Harden



Weethallie

Tuesday - SEPTEMBER 5th

Depart West Wyalong to WEETHALLIE

Silo location – Railway Street, Weethallie

Continue travel on to DUBBO for overnight stay at

BLUE DIAMOND MOTOR INN, 113/115 Wingewarra Street, \$150/night, 10 Queen, 5 Twin rooms

Phone (02) 6882 0666

TOTAL 380 KMS FOR DAY



Dunedoo



Quirindi



Merriwa

Wednesday - SEPTEMBER 6th

Depart Dubbo to DUNEDOO

Silo location – Castlereagh Highway, Dunedoo

Continue to MERRIWA

Silo location – Hackets Road, Merriwa

Continue to QUIRINDI via SCONE

Silo location – Quirindi

Overnight stay at BEST WESTERN MOTEL/RSL, \$148/night, two people

Phone (02) 6746 1995

TOTAL 340 KMS FOR DAY



Barraba



Gunnedah

Thursday - SEPTEMBER 7th

Depart Quirindi to BARRABA,

Silo location – Manilla Road, Barraba

Continue travel to GUNNEDAH

Silo location – 2 Barber Street, Gunnedah

Overnight stay at the HARVEST LODGE MOTEL, 404 Conadilly Street, \$160 for night, 2 people

Phone: (02) 6742 3400

TOTAL 260 KM FOR DAY

Friday - SEPTEMBER 8th

Depart Gunnedah to PORTLAND

Silo location – William Street, Portland

NO MOTEL ORGANISED, SOME MAY WISH TO TRAVEL HOME.

IF NOT, BOOK A MOTEL

TOTAL 350 KMS FOR DAY TO PORTLAND



Portland

If interested call either Denis Kasza on 0407 492 008, Terry Bancroft 0409 323 133 or email bangers@bancroft.id.au



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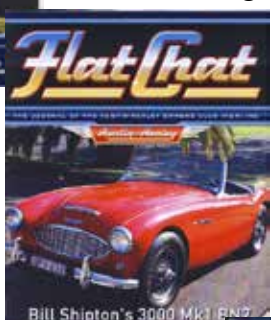
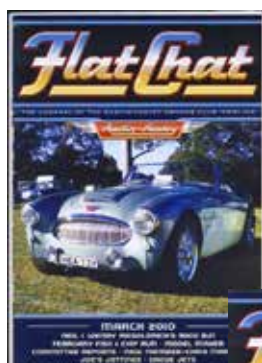
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Flat Chat Back Issues

Interested in receiving backcopies of Flat Chat?
Now available, digital copies of Flat Chat for 2005
through to March 2023.

That's 200+ issues for you to read at your leisure.
Free and gratis to members. All you have to do is send
a 1-3GB USB (thumb) drive to me at the below address
along with a stamped self-address envelope.



Patrick Quinn
"Wongaburra"
116 Warks Hill Road
Kurrajong Heights
NSW 2758

You can give me the drive (&
stamp) at a meeting.



Graham Healey's 'new' Austin-Healey

After some time without one, club member Graham Healey is now pleased as punch to be the owner of a 3000 Mk1 BT7 (HBT7/3115).

I suppose from an editor's perspective, Graham's 'new' Austin-Healey goes back to the March 2010 issue of Flat Chat, which happened the first issue I put together. Back then in my enthusiasm, I prepared articles on new AHOC members, and that issue included the story of how Christopher Marson, a dentist living in the vicinity of South West Rocks, had purchased a UK delivered Mk1 in 1977 when he was working in England, and brought it back to Australia with him.

Time moved on, and occasionally I would hear from Christopher until it all went quiet, and his name disappeared from the membership list.

Then in June last year the AHOC received an email through the website, from Christopher's daughter with the sad news that her father had died, and that she and her sister would like help in making sure that the 3000 went to a good home. A digital copy of the March 2010 issue of Flat Chat was sent to her with the advice that someone will be back in contact with her.



Christopher Marson and 3000 in 2010

First thing to do was to have a looksee at the car, so the message was passed on to Mid-North Coast members Phil and Anthea Lorking. I'm pleased to say that Phil was happy to do so, and arrangements were duly made. After a good look at the car Phil reported that the 3000 had clearly not seen daylight for some years and that rats and mice had been enjoying the Austin-Healey as their home. Phil kindly sent a batch of photos that showed that the car hadn't moved for some time.



One of Phil Lorking's photos.

In August last year, Graham Healey mentioned to Colin Rule that he was looking for an everyday Austin-Healey for himself and his family to enjoy. Of course, one and one equals and the photos were sent on to Colin and then on to Graham.

See below an email received from Graham Healey just a week or so ago for *Flat Chat*.

Counting down the hours till I pick up my Austin-Healey 3000 Mk1 BT7. The car is currently located in South West Rocks where it's been garaged for 10 years. It was previously owned by Christopher Marson, where it was featured in Flat Chat magazine in March, 2010. He bought the car in 1977 while living in the UK, and shipped the car over to Australia in 1990. The engine was blueprinted and fitted with a big camshaft, and currently sports a side exhaust. I am looking forward to bringing the car back to its former glory, with the help of my two sons, who are looking forward to learning to drive their first Austin-Healey. I have not as yet seen the car, so I am excited for the first viewing. It was inspected by AHOC member Phil Lorking in August 2022, who noted that the body paint is in poor shape and the front guards are fibreglass. There seems to be no rust, but the interior needs some work, as vermin have had a field trip. The previous owners installed a new battery and found that the electrics all seem to work.

Along with help from Chris Dimmock, I pick the car up on February 25th and bring it back for a restoration. I plan to get the car on the road as soon as possible, as I want a driving car, something the family can enjoy.

Graham's new AH

So, wish us good luck and hope to see you on the road soon.

Then on Sunday February 26 I saw the following (and photos) from Chris Dimmock on Facebook.

Road trip Saturday!

With Graham Healey.

Left home at 6.30am. Just home now at 10.30pm.

Drove just over 1,000 km today.

Met Graham at 8.00am at Colin Rule's place to pick up the trailer, then up to South West Rocks.

Loaded Graham's new acquisition onto the trailer, drove back to Colin's and dropped the car and trailer at Cols, then home! All done in a day!

Just fantastic to have a Healey back in a Healey!!

Really looking forward to seeing Graham Healey and family out and about in the 3000. By the way, in case you don't know Graham is Donald's grandson.

The below photos tell the story of a long Saturday.



AHOC's Illawarra and Southern Highlands Chapters



You are invited to the inaugural gathering on
Monday 20th March 2023.
Meet at 10:00am

To get this going in a “Big” way we have organised a great photo opportunity.
for you and your Austin-Healey

beneath the wings of

Qantas VH-OJA Boeing 747-438

at the Historical Aircraft Restoration Society (HARS)
Shellharbour Airport, 54 Airport Road, Shellharbour Airport, Albion Park Rail NSW 2527.

If you are coming south on the M1 Princes Motorway, take the turn off into Albion Park Rail
as the new M1 Princes Motorway now by-passes Albion Park Rail.

We are looking to get a large group of Austin-Healeys into the 747 compound,
and have them parked under the wings of the 747 for photos.

So, if you are interested in Austin-Healeys, own one or have been an owner of an Austin-Healey, come on down to the Illawarra and join us for a great day, morning tea or lunch at the café at the HARS Museum.

Take the opportunity to take a tour of the Museum.

The display of aircraft is constantly changing.

Tours are hosted by very knowledgeable guides.

Concession entry to the museum including guided tour: \$20.00 per head.

To confirm your parking spot RSVP:

John Thornton:

Email: John.thornton2011@outlook.com

Mobile: 0419 266 284



Unforgettable memories...



RALLY NEWS

February 2023

Two months to go!

HEALEYS IN THE HUNTER is getting close!

It's not too late! We still have room for more attendees if you decide the **Hunter Valley** is a great choice for a 3 night stay for the **National Rally**! There are still rooms available at **Chateau Elan**, but don't delay.

After 31 January the **Chateau Elan** will accept bookings from non-Rallyers. Get in quick or risk not being there at all.

As the most interesting **wineries** tend to be the smallest ones, we couldn't book specific winery visits for our numbers. Instead, we have identified some wineries that you might like to visit on your way back to **Chateau Elan** from the organised drives or from **Tocal Homestead**. Check your welcome pack for details.

Our **program of events** now looks like this:

Tuesday 2 May

Check in to **Chateau Elan** from 3pm and pick up your welcome pack at **Rally Registration**. Then at **7pm** join everyone on the **Fairway Lawn** for Canapes (finger food) and drinks.



Wednesday 3 May

Up early for a final polish, then drive your car to the **Austin-Healey display** to view the other cars (**10am to 12 noon**). Enjoy **Hunter Valley Gardens** or browse the shops at **Pokolbin Village**, taste some wine or vodka, or pick up a memento or two, or just stop for coffee and cake.

Wednesday afternoon is your opportunity for a visit to the **Spa** or play a round of **Golf** at the Vines (advance bookings essential, contact **Chateau Elan**) or just enjoy the **Hunter Valley**. There is so much to visit, see and enjoy in the Hunter, from the **Army Infantry Museum** at Singleton to the **artisan cheesemakers, brewers**, or follow a **convict trail**. It is all there for your enjoyment.

This evening is **Party Night – Do the Healey Hop!** Your two course dinner begins at 7pm in the **Founders Room**, followed by as much dancing as anyone could want, or just enjoy chatting to friends old and new. Our band is **Bad Sneakers** who play great 60s and 70s danceable music. Bring your **best or worst sneakers, decorated or plain, they might win a prize!**

Thursday 4 May

This morning enjoy an organised country drive to historic **Tocal Homestead in Paterson** for a tour and light lunch. This is a picturesque and historic house and farm dating from the 1820s and 1830s. After lunch, continue to historic **Hunter port town of Morpeth**, and perhaps take a stroll through **Kurri Kurri** to view the more than **60 fabulous murals** scattered throughout the village on the way back to **Chateau Elan**. Or you can join our guided drive to picturesque **Wollombi village**.

For something different: **Maitland Art Gallery** is well worth a visit and has a great coffee shop; be wowed by the gorgeous views from the **Audrey Wilkinson winery's** hilltop location; or from the **Mt Bright lookout**; or maybe book a **Go-Kart** session at nearby Kearsley and then test your putting prowess on the adjacent **Mount Panorama mini-golf**. These and more are available for your enjoyment!

Thursday afternoon is your opportunity for a round of **Golf** at the Vines or to be pampered at the **Spa** (early bookings essential for both). Book asap to ensure you get pampered!

This evening is the **Gala Dinner**. Once again, we will congregate in the **Founders Room** for a Gala dinner to wrap up this Rally and to learn about the 2024s Rally which will be held in WA.

Friday 5 May

Sadly, this morning it is time to pack our bags and say goodbye until next year. Join everyone for a **Farewell Brunch** in the restaurant.

Should you have any questions about the rally please do not hesitate to contact the committee via the designated email rally2023ahocnsw@hotmail.com and one of the rally committee will reply depending on your query.

That's it for now, look out for more news next month!

Your Rally Committee

We look forward to sharing unforgettable memories with you....we do hope you can join us! Don't delay, book today!



Photo by Tracy Appel, [https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:147 - Tocal Homestead \(5045676b2\).jpg](https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:147_-_Tocal_Homestead_(5045676b2).jpg)

Tocal Homestead <https://www.tocalhomestead.com.au/>



Photos from top left: Kurri Kurri Town of Murals, Bushfire Cricket and Nature Lover, Town of Morpeth, the Monument in Morpeth with all the historic buildings and the clock tower, Town of Wollombi and the Army Infantry Museum in Singleton



Forged pistons for a Bugeye

By Scott Graham



I have owned a Bugeye since the age of 19. About 15 years back, I decided to upgrade my 1275cc engine with a locally made crossflow head, topped with twin 45 DCOE Webers. Built by the demon tweaker Graham Russell, the resulting engine produced 150HP on the engine dyno and about 120FT/lb of torque – flat across the range. It idles like a dream at 700rpm and pootles around town like a Japanese shopping cart. However when driven in anger, it's a scary/wonderful snarling beast. The only issue with it, is that for some unknown reason we built it around a set of standard diecast pistons.

The possibility of one of these breaking, and grenading my beautiful engine, has always bothered me and has me staying well below the theoretical maximum revs for the motor – the 150HP came at below 7,000rpm and the power was still climbing strongly at that point.

Fast forward to last year when I had to remove the engine and gearbox because of a problem with the spigot bush (don't ask), and I thought I'd take the opportunity to treat the car to some forged pistons.

Turned out, as these things do, that the process was quite a journey. My engine had been bored out to 1361cc, requiring 73mm pistons which are not available off the shelf as a forged offering. Quotes were sought from all the usual US and UK suppliers, and they proved prohibitively expensive and slow in getting here. The solution was found locally at Colin Medwin's Special Piston Services (SPS) in Melbourne, who produced a wonderful hand-crafted product, at a fraction of the cost of the international guys. What's more, despite the added weight that comes with the denser material and lower silicon content, his experience in modifying A-series pistons over the years, meant he was able to remove enough material, that they turned out lighter than the diecast pistons they are replacing. So, it's a win all around.

In the pic you see the SPS forged product alongside the diecast product its replacing. It's the shiny one!

The engine goes back together shortly, and I'm hoping that I'll be able to push it harder on the track and extract the extra power without the worry.





Thanks again to Bryan Levy for the above photos.

I thought the 100 between the two Porkers was akin to a rose between two thorns and surely the approach to the Sydney Harbour Bridge is one of the best places in Sydney to show off the torque (and sound) of an Austin-Healey.

APR
23



THIRLMERE RAIL MUSEUM

10 Barbour Rd Thirlmere
11am - 2.30pm

MEET AT PARTRIDGE VC REST STOP, HUME
MOTORWAY 10AM FOR 10.30 DEPARTURE
CAFÉS AND PARKING AVAILABLE AT THIRLMERE

Austin-Healey 3000 bores in a 100/6 block.

By Mike Salter

Over the years I have been asked many times if there is any good reason why a 100/6 (3.125" bore) should not be overbored to 3000 specifications (3.281").

Back, before I knew better, I believed that there was no good reason not to do so, and in fact we successfully rebuilt more than one 100/6 engine to standard 3000 specs.

We never realized how lucky we were.

In the late '90s we had a customer bring in a 100/6 that was having problems as a result of coolant leaking into the oil. The leakage only seemed to occur when the engine was warm and the cooling system was at operating pressure. After a long and involved period of analysis we discovered that the water was leaking through a tiny crack in the block about half way down one of the bores.

Our local race engine shop had recently acquired a sonic cylinder wall thick tester and using that piece of new technology we determined that the walls of that block were perilously thin in many areas as a

result of being bored to 3000 specifications and the only solution was to rebuild the engine with a 3000 block.

After I read in Geoff Healey's book "The Story of the Big Healeys" that the engine block had to be redesigned to produce the 3000 I put two and two together and decided not to "overbore" any more 100/6 blocks.

Unfortunately, this problem was not common knowledge and just before I sold my business we purchased a "race ready" 3000 for a long time customer never imagining that the engine had been produced from a 100/6 block.

The engine ran for about 20 minutes before it "grenaded".

The following photos illustrate the result and should serve as testimony as to the folly of "overboring" a 100/6 block.



Bent Rod



Lets the air in



Something missing



Engine debris

FOR SALE

1955 Austin-Healey 100 BN1

This car has been in the same ownership for over 25 years and is in very nice condition.

It has travelled on many Charlie's Runs, as well as other Austin-Healey Owners Club runs.

There has had only minor modifications, such as heat shields for the fuel system and spin on/off oil filter.

Also recently had radiator out and flushed and a new thermostat fitted.

Finished in Old English White with some panels recently refinished. Red leather upholstery and red carpet.

Currently road registered. \$78,000
Please call Harold Johnston on 0411 519 959.



1960 Austin Healey BT7 MK11 (tri-carb). Genuine 93,000 miles. full history, documents and receipts since purchased in 1979. Genuine factory hardtop, professionally maintained by the Classic Car Garage for many years. For more detailed information, contact John Burch phone 0411 195 088.



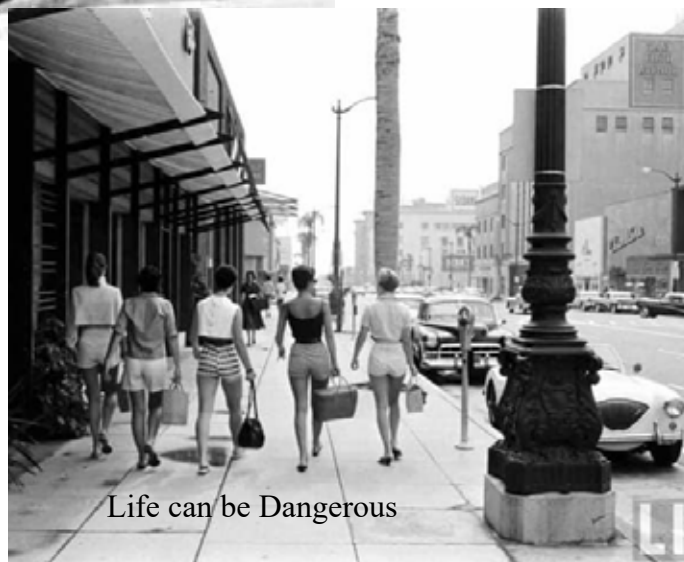
Your Last Page



Motor Racing
is
Dangerous



Work can be Dangerous



Life can be Dangerous



Exporting can be Dangerous



Safety at Last

Monthly Meetings

**We meet on the first Thursday of the month at Strathfield Golf Club
Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm**